

Alejandro García Castellanos

Ph.D. Candidate in Machine Learning
AMLab, University of Amsterdam

Email: a.garciacastellanos@uva.nl
Personal Page: agarciacast.github.io
Google Scholar: [Alejandro García-Castellanos](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applying topology, geometry, and algebra to the representation learning and generative modeling of shapes for enhanced human-AI collaboration.

EXPERIENCE

Ph.D. Candidate

Feb. 2024 – Present

AMLab (Amsterdam Machine Learning Lab), UvA

Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Under the supervision of Erik Bekkers (UvA) and co-supervision of Daniël Pelt (ULEI)
- Sponsored by [The Hybrid Intelligence Centre](#)
- Geometry-informed machine learning techniques for collaborative human-computer image annotation

Research Engineer

Mar. 2023 – Feb. 2024

RPL (Division of Robotics, Perception and Learning), KTH

Stockholm, Sweden

- Under the supervision of Danica Kragic
- Metric learning in generative models
- Hierarchy discovery in Hyperbolic geometry

Trainee Internship

Sep. 2020 – Jan. 2021

MEDAL laboratory, CTB (Center of Biomedical Technology)

Madrid, Spain

- Under the supervision of Ernestina Menasalvas
- Development of new techniques for information recognition in medical corpus
- Fine-tuning an LLM in breast and lung cancer's clinical notes

EDUCATION

MSc in Machine Learning

Sep. 2021 – Oct. 2023

KTH Royal Institute of Technology

Stockholm, Sweden

- Average grade: 4.00 GPA
- Applied Mathematics elective track: Topological Data Analysis, Regression Analysis, Time Series Analysis
- Thesis in *“Topological regularization and relative latent representations”*

B.S. in Mathematics and Computer Science

Sep. 2017 – Jul. 2021

Universidad Politécnica de Madrid

Madrid, Spain

- Average grade: 9.78/10.0 (4.00 GPA)
- Best academic record amongst all programs at the ETSIINF (Higher Technical School of Computer Engineers) of the promotion 2020/2021
- Honours granted by UPM in 29 courses
- Three Scholarships for Academic Excellence granted by the Community of Madrid
- Thesis in *“Robustness of Persistent Homology: the Stability Theorem”*

SKILLS

Programming: Python, Java, C, R, SQL, MATLAB, Maple, Prolog, Bash

ML Frameworks: PyTorch, PyTorch Lightning, JAX, TensorFlow

Tools: $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git, Microsoft Office, Keynote, Pages, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Lightroom

Soft Skills: public speaking, written communication, teamwork, project and time management, critical thinking, analytical skills, research skills, creativity, strategic thinking

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Reinforcement Learning

2025, 2026

Teaching assistant

Master In Artificial Intelligence, UvA

Deep Learning 2

2024, 2025

Teaching assistant and project supervisor

Master In Artificial Intelligence, UvA

Master Thesis Supervisor

2025

Thesis: “Persistent Homology Go Combinatorial”

Master In Artificial Intelligence, UvA

Master Thesis Supervisor

2026

Thesis: “Fisher-Weighted Riemannian Model Merging”

Master In Artificial Intelligence, UvA

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

(* := EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

- AISTats '26 **A. García-Castellanos***, A. A. Medbouhi*, G. L. Marchetti, D. M. Pelt, E. J. Bekkers, D. Kragic (2025). “*Randomized HyperSteiner: A Stochastic Delaunay Triangulation Heuristic for the Hyperbolic Steiner Minimal Tree*”. In: *Proceedings of the 29th International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Statistics (AISTATS)*
- NeurIPS '25 **A. García-Castellanos**, D. R. Wessels, N. J. Berg, R. Duits, D. M. Pelt, E. J. Bekkers (2025). “*Equivariant Eikonal Neural Networks: Grid-Free, Scalable Travel-Time Prediction on Homogeneous Spaces*”. In: *Proceedings of the 39th Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*.
- ALENEX '25 **A. García-Castellanos***, A. A. Medbouhi*, G. L. Marchetti, E. J. Bekkers, D. Kragic (2025). “*Hypersteiner: Computing heuristic hyperbolic steiner minimal trees*”. In: *2025 Proceedings of the Symposium on Algorithm Engineering and Experiments (ALENEX)*.
- TAG-DS '25 O. Boufalis*, J. Carrasco-Pollo*, J. Rosenthal*, E. Terres-Caballero*, **A. García-Castellanos** (2025). “*Symmetry-Aware Graph Metanetwork Autoencoders: Model Merging through Parameter Canonicalization*”. In: *Proceedings of the 1st Conference on Topology, Algebra, and Geometry in Data Science (TAG-DS)*. **Oral presentation.**
- UniReps '24 **A. García-Castellanos**, G. L. Marchetti, D. Kragic, M. Scalamiero (2024). “*Relative representations: Topological and geometric perspectives*”. In: *Proceedings of the II edition of the Workshop on Unifying Representations in Neural Models (UniReps)*.

PREPRINTS & MANUSCRIPTS

(* := EQUAL CONTRIBUTION)

- TAG-DS '26 **A. García-Castellanos**, M. Weiler, E. J. Bekkers (2026). “*RoVE: Rotary Value Embeddings Attention for Relative Position-dependent Value Pathways*”. In: *Extended Abstract track of the 2nd Conference on Topology, Algebra, and Geometry in Data Science (TAG-DS)*. **Oral Spotlight.**
- TAG-DS '26 E. Terres-Caballero, **A. García-Castellanos** (2026). “*Fisher-Weighted Riemannian Model Merging for Orthogonal Fine-Tuning*”. In: *Extended Abstract track of the 2nd Conference on Topology, Algebra, and Geometry in Data Science (TAG-DS)*. **Oral Spotlight.**
- GRaM '26 **A. García-Castellanos**, G. Bellaard, R. Duits, D. M. Pelt, E. J. Bekkers (2026). “*Generalized Reduction to the Isotropy for Flexible Equivariant Neural Fields*”. In: *Extended Abstract track of the ICLR 2026 Workshop on Geometry-grounded Representation Learning and Generative Modeling (GRaM)*.

UniReps '25 (Ext. Abs.)	B. Kuipers*, F. Byrman*, D. Uyterlinde* A. García-Castellanos (2025). <i>“Symmetry-Aware Fully-Amortized Optimization with Scale Equivariant Graph Metanetworks”</i> . In: <i>Extended Abstract track of the III edition of the Workshop on Unifying Representations in Neural Models (UniReps)</i> .
GRaM '24 (Blog post)	D. Canez*, N. Midavaine*, T. Stessen*, J. Fan*, S. Arias*, A. García-Castellanos (2024). <i>“Effect of equivariance on training dynamics”</i> . In: <i>Blog post track of the I edition of the Workshop on Geometry-grounded Representation Learning and Generative Modeling (GRaM)</i> .
GRaM '24 (Blog post)	M. Carrasco*, A. Berentzen*, A. García-Castellanos (2024). <i>“Applications of TopoX to Equivariant Topological Networks”</i> . In: <i>Blog post track of the I edition of the Workshop on Geometry-grounded Representation Learning and Generative Modeling (GRaM)</i> .

INVITED TALKS

Applied Topology Day at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam <i>Amsterdam, Netherlands</i>	June 2026
4th workshop on Mathematics and AI <i>Tilburg, Netherlands</i>	June 2025
Learning on Graphs Conference <i>Amsterdam, Netherlands</i>	November 2024

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Reviewer <i>NeurIPS Proceedings</i>	2025
Reviewer <i>NeurReps Workshop</i>	2025
Reviewer <i>UniReps Workshop</i>	2024
Reviewer <i>ICML Proceedings</i>	2024

LANGUAGES

English: Advanced level (C1), CAE by Cambridge English

Spanish: Native language

German: Low Beginner Level